Thursday, November 16

Israeli Defense Minister Gallant says that evidence was discovered inside Al-Shifa that linked the facility and the fate of Israeli hostages. It would be helpful if Gallant could be more precise in his frequent announcements. For the time being, there is no evidence proving that Al-Shifa was a Hamas command center and that its senior leadership was holed up there. Repeated announcements without proof do not help the Israeli information campaign, a campaign increasingly important and not very successful up to now. One point in Gallant's announcements was sadly proven correct: the corpse of Yehudit Weiss from Kibbutz Be'eri, who was taken hostage on October 7 and whose husband was murdered on that day, was found near Al-Shifa. Yehudit was diagnosed with breast cancer a few months ago. She was murdered by her kidnappers and weapons were found nearby.

Israel allowed some fuel to be delivered to Gaza. The chief of staff, in a conversation with the troops in Gaza, said that Israel was ready to widen its operations to other parts of the enclave. Gallant had said as much previously. The extension of ground operations to the south of the enclave will depend in some measure on the attitude of the US. The dire situation of the population needs to be taken into account. And what about the hostages in all of this? Forty-eight soldiers have been killed so far in the campaign.

The rise of antisemitism in western Europe and the US shows that hatred of Jews was merely dormant since World War II and the Holocaust, and that any pretext can revive it. This hatred is being amalgamated with social conflicts that have nothing to do with it. Jews are portrayed as oppressors, either directly oppressing the Palestinians or using the money they have supposedly accumulated to oppress any possibly disadvantaged social group. Antisemitism certainly is the oldest hatred, and it does not end. In the US, at least, the Jews react forcefully, although there is no way to stop the constant tirades of well-known personalities such as Elon Musk.